

22nd rank in April 2020. I am unable to explain this sudden jump in ranking within a short period of 12 months. One hypothesis could be that some sector of the software industry, which thrived on the work-from-home mode of operation in the COVID year, adopted Delphi or Object Pascal. But I can't really give any data to corroborate this hypothesis. At the same time, it was really surprising to know that the language is ranked higher than languages like Ruby, Go, Swift, R, Perl, etc. In the latest IEEE Spectrum ranking of programming languages, Delphi (as mentioned earlier, a dialect of Object Pascal) is ranked 29th, which is better than the rank of programming languages like Perl, Clojure, Lua, Prolog,

etc. In the latest PYPL Popularity of Programming Languages ranking scheme, Delphi is ranked in the 28th position. The RedMonk programming languages rankings for January 2021 places Pascal at a better position than Raku (Perl 6). Popularity on Stack Overflow and GitHub is considered for scoring by the RedMonk programming languages ranking scheme. Figure 1 shows the complete RedMonk programming languages ranking for January 2021.

Thus, it is clear that Pascal does impact the programming world even 50 years after the first program was written and executed in this language. Now, let us learn some

history of the Pascal programming language. Pascal was designed by Niklaus Wirth and first came into existence in 1970. It was influenced by two programming languages called ALGOL and Simula. Object Pascal, the object-oriented extension of Pascal, came into existence in 1986. Notice that, nowadays, Object Pascal is far more popular than the original Pascal language (a procedural language). The proprietary yet popular software development software called Delphi and the Delphi dialect of Object Pascal first came into existence in 1995. These were originally developed by a company called Borland Software Corporation. Turbo Pascal, also

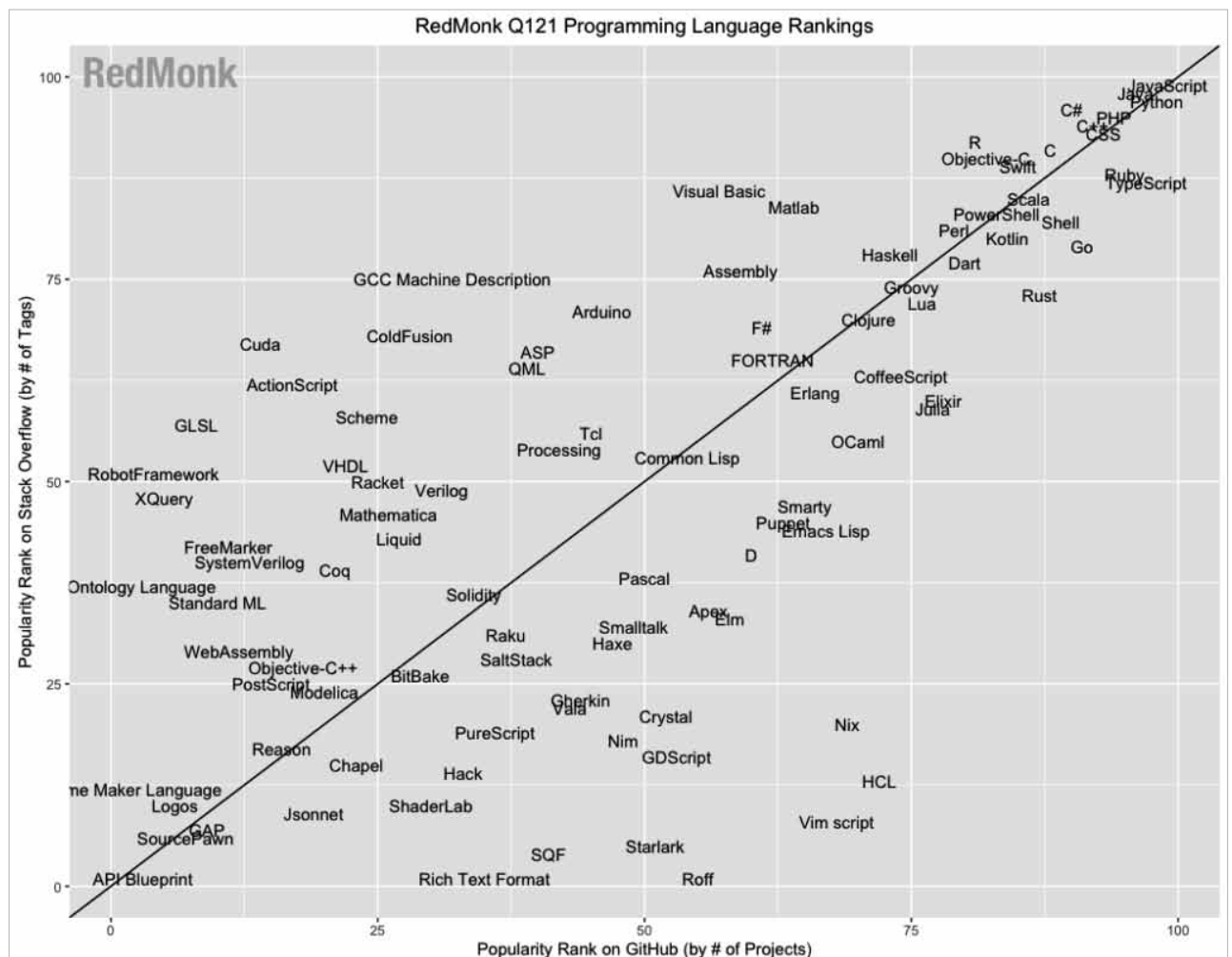


Figure 1: The RedMonk programming languages ranking (Image courtesy: RedMonk.com)